

No:SS/Misc(11)/2007

Dated: 06.07.2009

Subject: In water survey in lieu of Dry Docking of Cargo Vessels reg.

1. Regulation 10, Chapter-1, Part B of SOLAS 1974 as modified by 1988 protocol to SOLAS 1974 requires a minimum of two inspections of the outside of the ships' bottom during any period of five years, except where regulation 14 (e) or (f) is applicable. In all cases the interval between any two such inspections shall not exceed 36 months.
2. IMO resolution no. A-744(18) (Enhanced Survey Programme for Bulk Carriers and Tankers), as amended, provides underwater survey for bulk carriers and tankers with the ship in afloat condition, in lieu of intermediate dry docking (i.e., alternate inspection of the ship's bottom not conducted in conjunction with the SAFCON renewal survey), provided a suitable painting scheme which can last for 5 years is applied to under water hull area and there being no requirement of repairs in the hull that require dry docking of the vessel. For other types of vessels, such dispensation has to be granted by the Directorate in accordance with Rule 73(2) of M.S. (Cargo Ship Construction and Survey) Rules, 1991.
3. Keeping in view of the aforementioned rule provisions, the competent authority has decided following procedure in respect of underwater survey in lieu of intermediate dry docking:-
 - (a) For Oil Tankers and Bulk Carriers below 15 years of age, IRS, upon receipt of a request from owners, may carryout In-Water Survey in lieu of intermediate dry docking. On satisfactory completion of surveys, IRS may endorse the Statutory Certificates for completion of Intermediate Dry Docking. Thereafter, IRS shall forward a detailed report regarding the condition of the vessel and the survey findings along with their recommendation for acceptance of in-water survey in lieu of intermediate dry docking, to the Directorate, for ex-post-facto approval.
 - (b) For all other types of vessels other than bulk carriers and tankers, which are below 15 years of age, the present system of granting prior approval by the Directorate shall continue.
 - (c) Owners of all vessels below 15 years of age may, at their discretion, obtain In-Water Survey (IWS) notation for their vessels from IRS in order that their requests for grant of such permissions could be processed expeditiously.
4. Ship-owners may kindly note that for ships of 15 years of age and over, inspection of the

outside of the ship's bottom should be carried out with the ship in dry dock.

This issue with the approval of Chief Surveyor with the Govt. of India.

Sd/-
(Suresh Kumar)
Dy Chief Ship Surveyor
[Back to SHIPPING NOTICES main page](#)

